

Zero Integration Guide

GTMhack / Noodle (Lightfern Reach) - June 20, 2026

Summary

There is **no Zero integration in the codebase today**, but the project can integrate with [Zero](#) via its REST API and MCP server. The app is currently built for the Lightfern hackathon flow: Unify search -> research cards -> Gmail draft -> Lightfern Chrome extension.

What the project does today

The handoff layer (backend/src/handoff/index.ts) creates a Gmail draft from a research packet. It does **not** call Lightfern or Zero APIs. When Gmail OAuth is configured, it creates a real draft; otherwise it returns a prefilled Gmail compose deep-link. The user opens Gmail and runs the Lightfern extension to polish and send.

Current API endpoints:

- POST /api/brief - turns conversation into a search brief
- POST /api/run - search + research (SSE stream)
- GET /api/run/:id - run state
- POST /api/lightfern/handoff - Gmail draft handoff

How Zero fits

Zero is an AI-native CRM/GTM platform. Lightfern is an inbox drafting extension. They are separate products but serve the same workflow from different angles.

Layer	Noodle (this project)	Zero	Lightfern
Discovery	Unify / mock search	Lead Search (200M+ people)	-
Research	AI notes, angles, sources	AI Properties, notes	Contact history in inbox
CRM	-	Contacts, companies, deals, lists	-
Drafting	Starter email in Gmail	Automations -> Gmail drafts	Polish in Gmail/Outlook

Research packets map cleanly onto Zero records: match name, email, company, why_match, notes, suggested_angle, and sources.

Integration paths

1. Zero REST API (recommended)

Add a handoff endpoint that pushes research into Zero:

1. Create a contact - POST https://api.zero.inc/api/contacts
2. Attach a research note - POST https://api.zero.inc/api/notes
3. Add to a list via listIds (e.g. "Noodle prospects")
4. Optionally toggle a custom property (e.g. "Generate Outreach") to trigger a Zero automation that drafts email in Gmail

Auth: Bearer token from Workspace Settings -> API keys. Docs: https://docs.zero.inc/features/api/introduction

2. Zero MCP

Zero exposes an MCP server at <https://api.zero.inc/mcp> with OAuth. Tools include `add_contact`, `add_note`, and `add_contacts_to_list`. Useful for Cursor/agent workflows without custom backend code. Docs: <https://docs.zero.inc/features/mcp>

3. Replace Unify with Zero Lead Search

Zero already has lead discovery. Noodle could remain the natural-language -> research brief -> enriched context layer on top, using Zero instead of Unify for search.

4. Zero Sequences

After creating contacts, add them to a sequence source list to enroll in multichannel outbound (email, LinkedIn, phone). Docs: <https://docs.zero.inc/features/api/sequences>

Recommended architecture

User describes target

-> Noodle builds search brief + research cards

-> Handoff choice:

A) Gmail draft + Lightfern (current)

B) Zero contact + note + list + automation (new)

C) Both - Zero for CRM, Lightfern for final polish in Gmail

For a hackathon demo with Zero as your CRM, **Option B** is the strongest story: "Noodle finds and researches; Zero stores, enriches, and drafts."

What to build

Minimal scope (~1 endpoint + provider):

- ZERO_API_KEY and ZERO_WORKSPACE_ID in .env
- ZeroHandoffProvider mapping MatchCard -> contact + note
- UI button: "Save to Zero" alongside "Draft in Lightfern"

The existing HandoffService interface in `backend/src/types.ts` is the natural extension point alongside the Gmail handoff.

Bottom line

No plug-and-play Zero integration exists today, but Zero's API and MCP are a natural destination for research packets - especially if Zero is your team's CRM. Lightfern remains complementary for final email polish inside Gmail.

Generated from GTMhack project analysis. Zero docs: <https://docs.zero.inc>